I decided to base my hometown map off Claude Monet's Water Lilies and Japanese Bridge, which is an impressionistic painting that features many greens, blues, and a touch of lilac. Claude Monet is one of my favorite painters, and this piece in particular is so serene, and I wanted to convey that in my map as well. The colors of the land and the water align closely with other typical maps, my map is just a tad more muted. There are small touches of lilac, like in some labels, but overall, I wanted to continue to portray the serene feeling of Claude Monet's paintings. I used a color picker to choose what colors I wanted to use in my map, and with so many shades of blues and greens, I never ran out of options. When considering what features to show at different zoom levels, I focused on labels, waterways, roads, and bridges. Keeping the map proportional was a top priority, but so was keeping the map neat and readable. Waterways, roads, and bridges are aspects of infrastructure and the environment that aren't the same size at all scales and keeping them that way would distort understanding of regional geography for someone not familiar with the area. Ensuring that these layers were proportional was crucial to spatial understanding on the map. Zooming of the labels was done intentionally, depending on how zoomed out the map is, the vaguer the labels are, such as only showing the label of the continent. However, the more you zoom in, the more specific the labels are, going all the way to label each individual road. If the labels weren't adjusted for different zoom scales, all of the labels would show up at once, making the map hard to read, and some people just want the big picture without all of the specifics. I faced a lot of coding challenges, especially after making my Mapbox token private using an .env file. I used the code from the in class Mapbox exercise and used AI to create a new version for this project. There were a lot of errors with column names simply because I hadn't double checked the capitalization, but that was an easy fix. However, I had the most trouble with the CSV file of locations, and with so much content it was hard for me to pinpoint the parts that needed to be fixed. AI was very helpful in finding those inconsistencies and saved me a lot of time and frustration! I throughly enjoyed the chance to showcase my hometown with my favorite places while also customizing the map to be my own. The only complaint is that I wish the markers had more colors! They didn't have many

muted/lighter colors, so they clashed a little bit with my theme. However, I was very pleased with the array of icons available!